

Lab 14 - SOAR Alert Enrichment & Analyst Escalation

Tines Workflow Automation with AbuseIPDB Threat Intelligence

Objective: Build and validate a SOAR-style workflow that receives a simulated Splunk security alert, extracts an IP indicator, enriches it with AbuseIPDB, classifies the alert using lab-defined risk thresholds, and automatically routes the result either to analyst escalation or to a low/medium finalization path.

Environment

Component	Purpose
Tines Community Edition	SOAR-style workflow orchestration, webhook ingestion, branching, and event transformation
HTTP Request action	Simulates an external Splunk/SIEM alert source sending JSON to the webhook
Tines Webhook	Receives the security alert and exposes the alert fields to downstream actions
AbuseIPDB API	Enriches the suspicious IP with reputation and reporting data
Condition / Event Transform actions	Apply risk classification, routing, finalization, and analyst-escalation logic

Workflow Architecture

The blue **Simulate Splunk Alert** action is intentionally not connected by a Tines event-flow line to the webhook. It represents an external system sending an HTTP POST directly to the webhook URL.

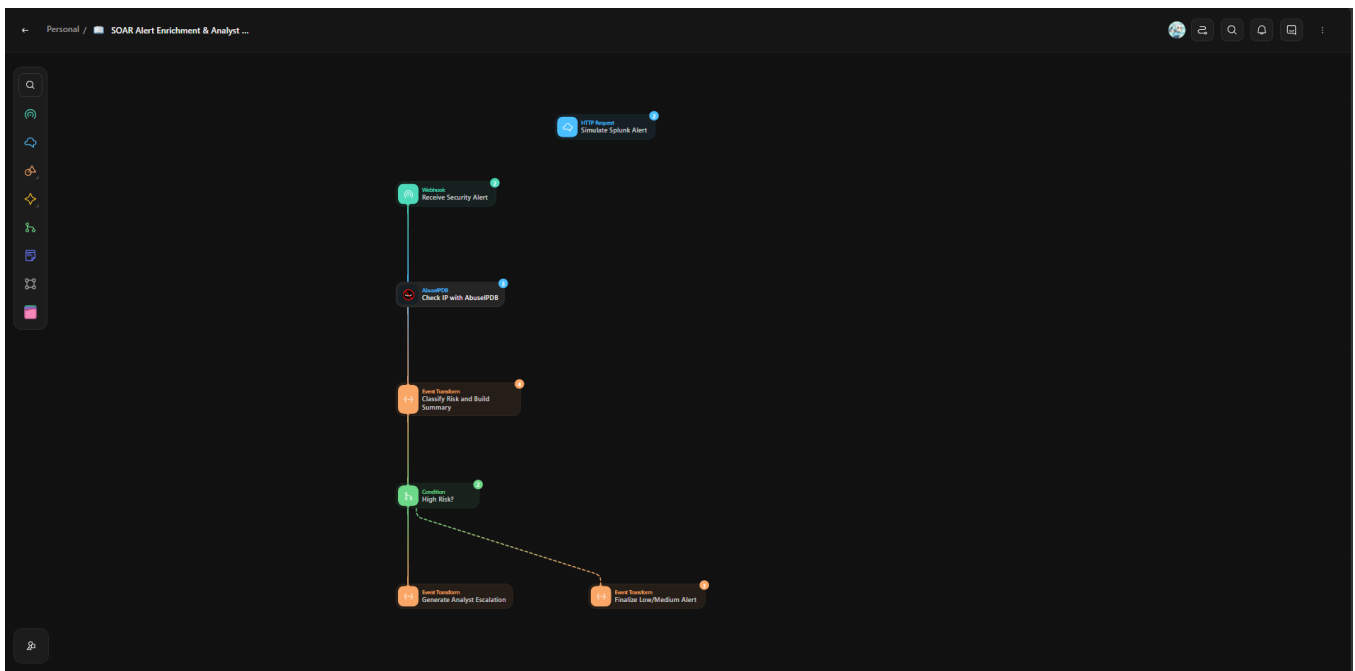


Figure 1 - Completed SOAR alert enrichment and routing workflow in Tines.

Alert Ingestion and IOC Extraction

A controlled JSON alert was sent to the Tines webhook. The payload contained an alert identifier, alert name, source, suspicious IP address, source severity, and description. The webhook successfully parsed the body and exposed the **ip_address** field for downstream enrichment.

```
{
  "alert_id": "SOC-2026-001",
  "alert_name": "Suspicious External IP Activity",
  "source": "Splunk",
  "ip_address": "118.25.6.39",
  "severity": "medium",
  "description": "Multiple suspicious connection attempts detected from an external IP."
}
```

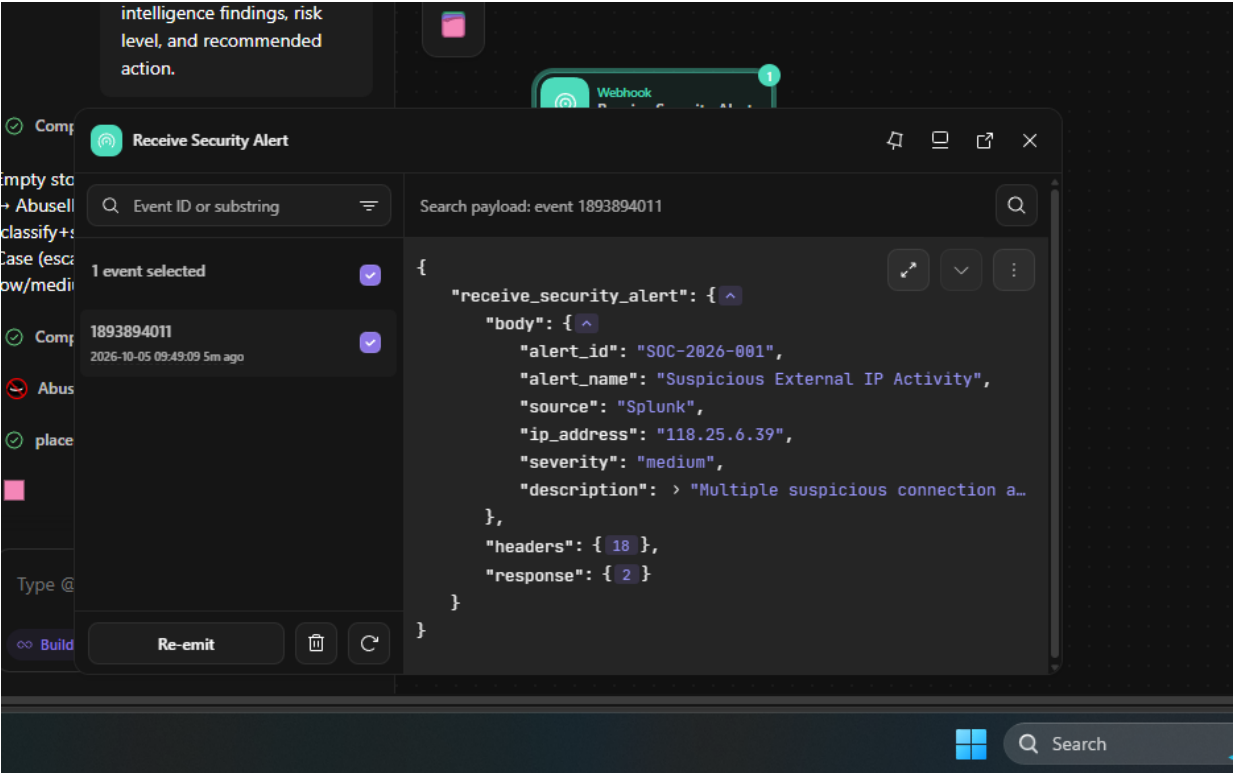


Figure 2 - Webhook event showing the six received alert fields, including the IP address.

IOC Reference

Field	Value
Dynamic Tines path	receive_security_alert.body.ip_address
Test IP	118.25.6.39
Alert source	Simulated Splunk-style alert
Validation result	Webhook received and parsed the alert successfully

AbuseIPDB Threat Intelligence Enrichment

The IP address was passed to AbuseIPDB through a configured credential and API action. The successful response returned reputation and contextual information used by the workflow for automated triage.

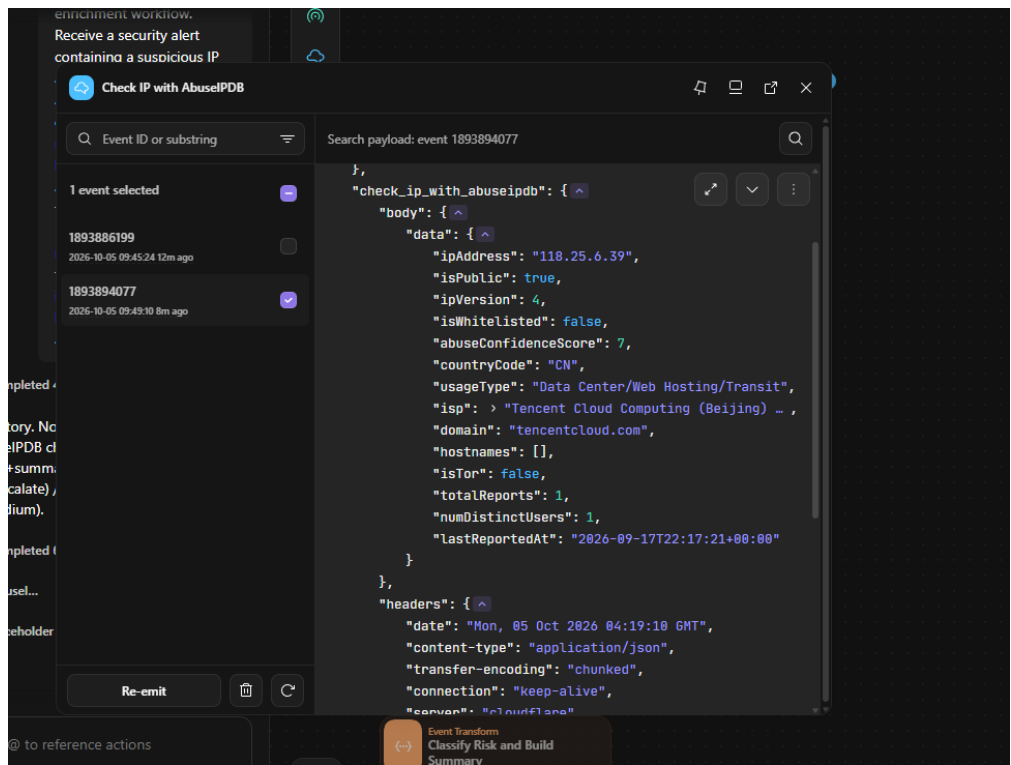


Figure 3 - Successful AbuseIPDB enrichment response for the test IP.

Enrichment field	Observed value
IP address	118.25.6.39
Abuse confidence score	7
Country code	CN
Usage type	Data Center/Web Hosting/Transit
Domain	tencentcloud.com
Total reports	1
Enrichment outcome	Successful API response

Risk Classification Logic

The following thresholds were defined specifically for this portfolio lab. They are **not official AbuseIPDB severity categories**.

Abuse confidence score	Lab-defined risk level
0-24	LOW
25-74	MEDIUM
75-100	HIGH

LOW-Risk Branch Validation

The real AbuseIPDB score returned for the test IP was **7**, which the lab logic classified as **LOW**. The **High Risk?** condition therefore did not match, and the event followed the no-match branch to **Finalize Low/Medium Alert**.

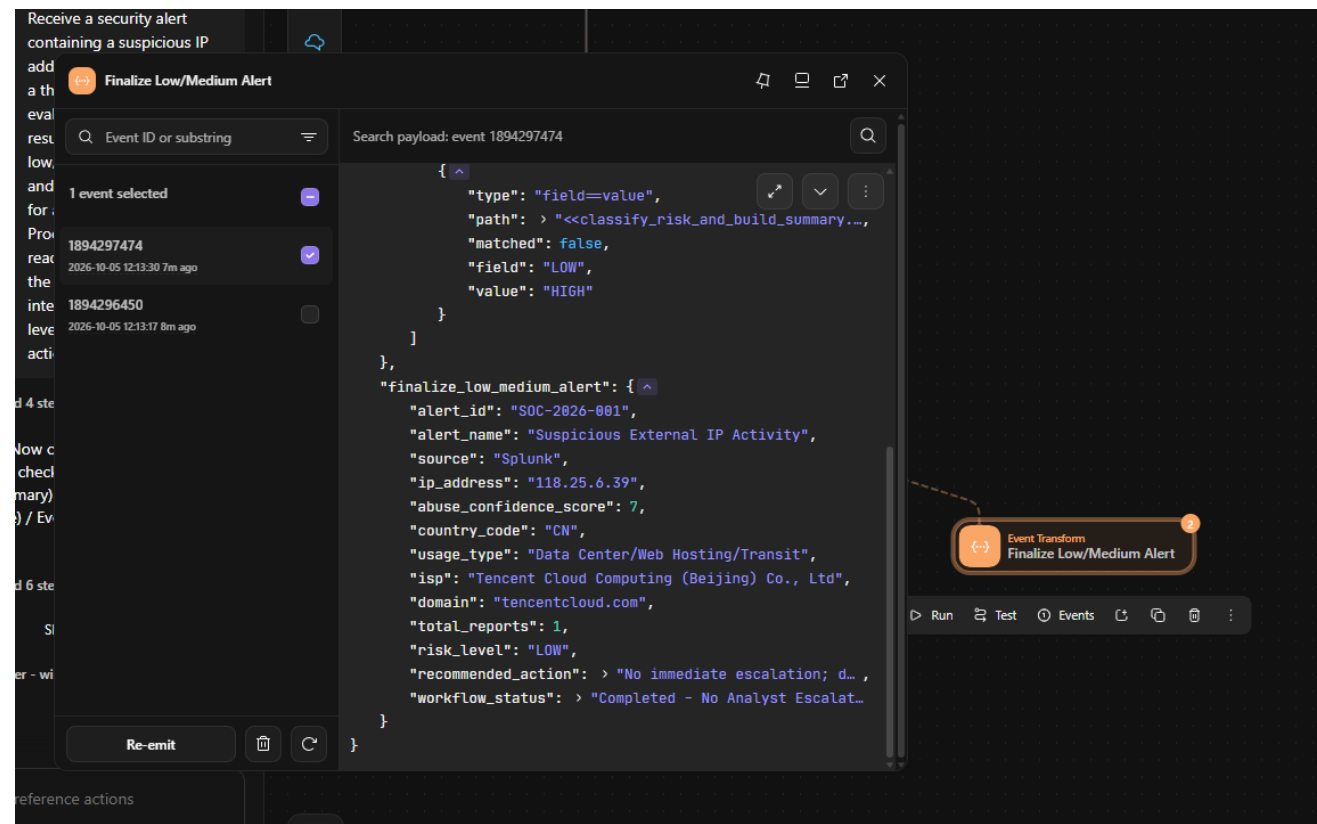


Figure 4 - Final LOW-risk event showing no analyst escalation was required.

Validation item	Result
Abuse confidence score	7
Risk level	LOW
High-risk condition	Not matched
Recommended action	No immediate escalation; document and monitor
Workflow status	Completed - No Analyst Escalation Required

Analyst interpretation: The enrichment data did not meet the lab-defined escalation threshold. The workflow retained the contextual information and produced a finalized analyst-ready event without escalation.

HIGH-Risk Routing Simulation

To validate the HIGH branch without misrepresenting live threat-intelligence data, a controlled test copy of the event was used. The abuse confidence score was changed from the real value of 7 to a simulated value of **90**. This simulation was used only to test branching and escalation behavior.

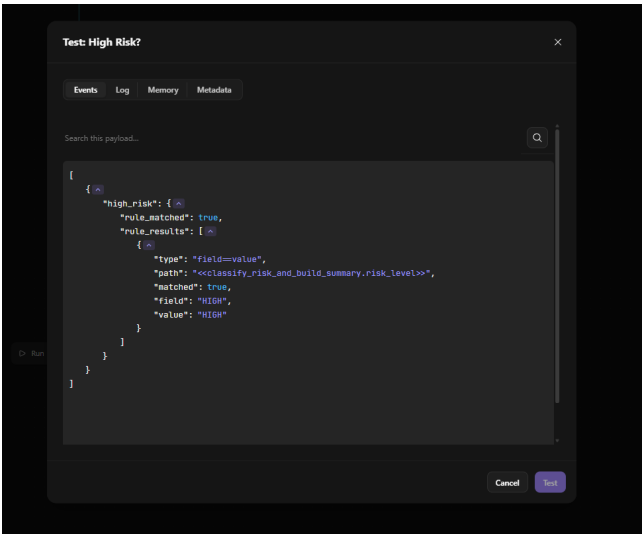


Figure 5 - Controlled HIGH-risk condition test showing HIGH equals HIGH and rule_matched = true.

Analyst Escalation Output

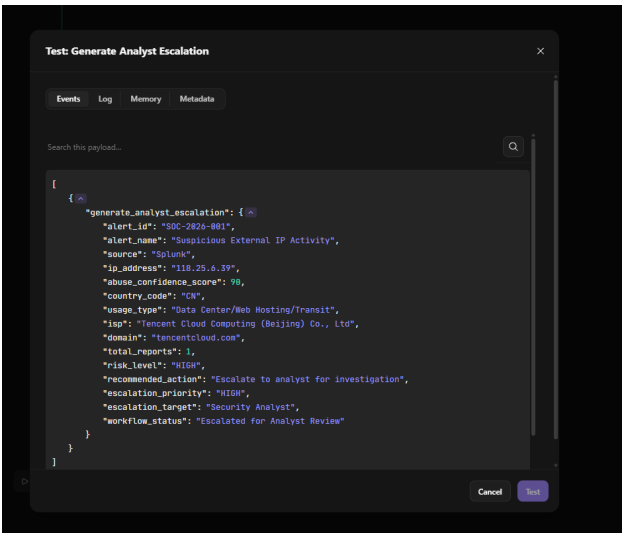


Figure 6 - Structured analyst-escalation record generated from the controlled HIGH-risk test.

Field	Controlled HIGH test result
Simulated abuse confidence score	90
Risk level	HIGH
Escalation priority	HIGH
Escalation target	Security Analyst
Workflow status	Escalated for Analyst Review

SOAR Workflow Assessment

Item	Assessment
Alert ingestion	Successful - simulated Splunk-style JSON received by Tines webhook
IOC extraction	Successful - IP address referenced dynamically from webhook payload
Threat-intelligence enrichment	Successful - AbuseIPDB API returned reputation data
Automated classification	Successful - LOW/MEDIUM/HIGH logic applied using lab-defined thresholds
LOW path	Validated - finalized without escalation
HIGH path	Validated using controlled simulated score - analyst escalation record generated
Case creation	Not used in this Community Edition environment; structured escalation event used instead

SOAR and Security Engineering Lessons

- SOAR workflows can reduce repetitive analyst work by automatically ingesting alerts, extracting indicators, enriching them, and applying consistent routing logic.
- Threat-intelligence scores should be treated as enrichment context rather than proof that an IP is malicious.
- Automated severity thresholds should be documented and tuned to the environment; the thresholds in this lab are portfolio-lab rules, not vendor-defined severity categories.
- Testing both matched and no-match branches is important when validating conditional security automation.
- Simulation data should be clearly separated from real enrichment evidence to avoid overstating findings.
- Credentials and webhook secrets should never be included in public screenshots, reports, or repositories.

Final Conclusion

Lab 14 successfully demonstrated an end-to-end SOAR-style security automation workflow in Tines. A simulated Splunk alert was received through a webhook, the IP indicator was enriched with AbuseIPDB, the enrichment was classified using documented lab-defined thresholds, and the alert was routed automatically. The real enrichment result produced a LOW-risk finalization path, while a controlled HIGH-risk simulation validated the analyst-escalation branch. The lab demonstrates practical experience with webhooks, REST API enrichment, conditional automation, analyst-ready event transformation, and security workflow design.

Safety note: This was a controlled portfolio lab. No malware was executed, no production systems were targeted, and the HIGH score of 90 was simulated solely to validate workflow routing. Secrets such as API keys and webhook tokens are intentionally excluded from the report.